

pax silica and the philippines

An independent review of the Economic Security Zone proposed at New Clark City in Tarlac, on 1,618.74 hectares. What has actually been signed, what is only being claimed, what the land and the grid can really support, and what the Philippines gains or loses either way.

[read the six findings →](#)[explore the exhibits](#)**US\$0**

INVESTMENT LEGALLY
COMMITTED AT THE CUTOFF

15 / 16

IMPLEMENTATION GATES
STILL OPEN

-34.8

NET PUBLIC SENTIMENT IN
JULY, FROM -1.0 PRE-
ACCESSION

+2.5pp

NET NEW TARIFF ON
PHILIPPINE GOODS FROM
THE COUNTERPARTY, 24
JUL 2026

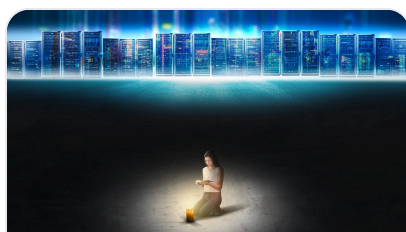
89 DAYS • ASEAN SUMMIT, NOVEMBER 2026

This report sets seven conditions that should be met before anyone signs. **none is met** as at the latest verification.

LATEST REPORTING

in the news

updated 2 August 2026 • 6 items • verified before listing



RAPPLER • 2
AUGUST 2026

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US STATE DEPARTMENT

US STATE DEPARTMENT •
31 JULY 2026

US welcomes Italy into Pax Silica as the 25th signatory

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Pax Silica Initiative

MANILA BULLETIN • 28
JULY 2026

DOE eyes nuclear to power Pax Silica AI hub in New Clark City

[read at mb.com.ph →](#)



CRUX • 28 JULY 2026

Filipino churches hit Marcos over US-planned AI hub in the Philippines

[read at cruxnow.com →](#)

PAXSILICA

RAPPLER • 27 JULY 2026

Energy Secretary Garin: Pax Silica at full load is 'too dangerous' to plug into the Luzon grid

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MANILA BULLETIN • 20
JULY 2026

Defense chief dismisses water scarcity fears for Pax Silica project

[read at mb.com.ph →](#)

the instrument does not describe the project

01

The only published Philippine legal instrument proposes a bilateral coordination office and states that the property "shall be used exclusively" for five coordination functions. It contains no reference to semiconductor packaging, data centres, mineral processing, or private locators. The public prospectus has no published legal basis.

0

REFERENCES TO INDUSTRY IN THE
OPERATIVE INSTRUMENT

the headline figures do not reconcile

02

Pairing US\$40–70bn with 130,000–190,000 direct jobs is unreconciled and jointly implausible: constructible on paper, but only with more back-end employment in this one site than the whole national industry supports today. The claimed PHP 68–75bn of annual withholding tax, which BCDA has confirmed is payroll withholding, implies average pay of PHP 2.13m, 2.4 times what a Philippine semiconductor engineer earns. The named anchor is expected to generate "thousands."

2.37x

CLAIMED EXPORTS VS. THE ENTIRE 2025
MERCHANDISE EXPORT BOOK

water and power are unsolved, not solved

03

Harvesting 90 MLD from rainfall needs a catchment of 1,460–3,129 hectares, or 90% to 193% of the site. 3 GW is 19.2% of the DOE's 15,600 MW projection for 2026 Luzon peak demand and 20.6% of the 14,534 MW actually recorded by mid-2026, on a grid that ran a 373 MW deficit under red alert in May 2026. The DFC is

the counterparty relationship is asymmetric

04

On 24 July 2026 a US 12.5% forced-labour tariff on Philippine goods took effect. Narrower than the headline: semiconductors and other Section 232 articles are exempt, and it replaced an expiring 10% measure, so the net increment is about +2.5 points. The direction is what matters.

funding an LNG feasibility study, not a solar one.

15,000 ha

LAND A SOLAR-POWERED 3 GW WOULD NEED. THE SITE IS 1,619.

The Philippines is being asked to grant land, water, power and rent forgone in exchange for a non-binding declaration and feasibility studies.

+2.5pp

NET TARIFF INCREMENT, FOUR MONTHS BEFORE THE PHILIPPINES IS ASKED TO SIGN

the public has already turned, and on the unanswered questions

05

Across 6,437 mentions from December to SONA eve, net sentiment fell from -1.0 before accession to -24.8 after, and to -34.8 in July alone. The economics are argued both ways. Water, land and governance are not debated at all; they run at net -44, -50 and -54. The best sentiment month on record was May, when the government publicly refused a US request.

-34.8

NET SENTIMENT IN JULY, THE MONTH OF MOST CLAIMS AND FEWEST DOCUMENTS

the strategic case is genuine, and some criticism is wrong

06

Comparative non-entanglement with Chinese capital is a real and time-limited asset. BPO at 7.4% of GDP faces AI displacement. And some of the most widely circulated environmental critiques do not survive scrutiny: silicon rather than nickel is the semiconductor input, and the light-pollution claim, while a legitimate and mitigable screening item, is substantially overstated as popularly framed.

7.4%

OF GDP: THE BPO EXPOSURE THAT MAKES AN ALTERNATIVE ENGINE URGENT

02

node, or not

What matters is whether the terms on the table in November beat the alternative. Both columns below are real; neither is costless.

PATH ONE

as a pax silica node

WHAT THE PHILIPPINES GAINS

- A named position inside an allied supply chain while comparative non-entanglement with Chinese capital is still a credible, time-limited asset.
- A credible upgrade path from back-end assembly into advanced packaging, where industry value is migrating as transistor scaling slows.
- An alternative growth engine as BPO, at 7.4% of GDP, faces AI-driven displacement.
- PHP 60bn of lease income over 25 years, plus the option value of first-mover designation in a network intended to span continents.
- Access to allied capital, the Stanford Foundry School curriculum, and Luzon Economic Corridor infrastructure momentum.

WHAT IT CARRIES OR FORGOES

- 1,618.74 hectares committed, possibly for 99 years, at a rent that is currently "to be discussed."
- 3 GW on a grid that ran a 373 MW deficit under red alert three months before this report.
- 65–90 MLD of what is, at that scale, watershed water, in a Type I climate with a pronounced dry season.
- An unquantified tax expenditure under CREATE MORE, including a 100% additional deduction on power for a multi-gigawatt load.
- A named role in a strategy whose own fact sheet states the objective of displacing rival supply chains, borne physically by the Philippines.

PATH TWO

outside pax silica

WHAT THE PHILIPPINES GAINS

No 99-year commitment, no grid increment, no watershed claim, no geopolitical targeting exposure.

The same capital, political attention and institutional bandwidth could close the ~50% industrial electricity cost gap with Indonesia and Vietnam, which benefits every existing locator, not one zone.

Freedom to lead with minerals leverage rather than land concessions, on the Indonesian model.

Supplier development and workforce programmes for an electronics base that already earns US\$46bn a year.

WHAT IT CARRIES OR FORGOES

Forgone lease income of PHP 60bn over 25 years, with a present value of about PHP 25.6bn.

Forgone option value on a strategic position, and reputational cost with Washington.

The allied-advantage window is time-limited and closes without being used.

The manufacturing gap keeps widening while Malaysia moves into semiconductors, Thailand into automotive and Indonesia into nickel processing.

THE ASSESSMENT'S OWN POSITION

Neither endorsement nor rejection. The Philippines should decline to sign in November unless seven disclosures and binding conditions are satisfied first. Its negotiating position will never again be as strong as it is between now and then: it holds the asset, it has not yet signed, and the counterparty wants a deliverable for a presidential visit tied to the 80th anniversary of bilateral relations. A deadline set by another country's summit calendar is the worst possible reason to accept undetermined terms.

Fourteen working models. Every input is a published figure; every formula is shown. Move the controls and the arithmetic moves with them.

EXHIBIT 01 • WATER

the catchment does not fit on the site

$$A = V \div (R \times C)$$

$$V = \text{demand} \times 365 \times 1,000 \text{ m}^3$$

daily demand

90 MLD

BCDA states 65–90 MLD demand and 120 MLD design capacity, expandable "to as much as 300 million liters per day through advanced technology".

annual rainfall

1,900 mm

Site-specific rainfall data are unpublished. The range covers normal rainfall for this part of Central Luzon.

runoff coefficient

0.55

0.90 happens only if nearly the whole site is paved over, which contradicts the promise to keep 40% of it open space.

CATCHMENT REQUIRED

3,144 ha

AS A SHARE OF THE SITE

194%

DRY-SEASON STORAGE, 180 DAYS

16.2 million m³

BOTH BARS ON ONE SCALE • 0 TO 3,332 HA

the site: 1,618.74 ha

catchment needed: 3,144 ha

At these parameters the catchment required is larger than the entire parcel. The water must come from beyond the site boundary, which makes it watershed water, and therefore water that Tarlac's households and irrigators are already using.

The maths proves something narrow, but decisive. BCDA's plan to catch the water on the site itself fails at the top of BCDA's own demand estimate. At 65 million litres a day, with good rainfall, catching it on site is arguable. At 90 million, it is not. What taking that water would do to people downstream is a separate question, and the maths cannot answer it. Holding water back could capture rainy-season flow that currently runs to the sea unused. It could equally cut the supply people depend on in the dry months. Telling those two apart needs a study of the whole river system, including how much water it has to keep flowing to stay healthy. No such study exists. Until one does, the burden of proof sits with BCDA. BCDA has since described an expansion path to 300 MLD, at which every figure here scales by 3.3 times, to a required catchment of roughly 4,900–10,400 hectares. The storage figures are rough upper limits for a first check, not an engineering design.

EXHIBIT 02 • POWER

3 gigawatts has to come from somewhere

share of energy served by solar

20%

all gas

all solar

3,000 MW

SOLAR NAMEPLATE
REQUIRED

3,000 ha

LAND AT THE ACWA
BENCHMARK OF 1 HA/MW

2,400 MW

FIRM GAS CAPACITY
STILL REQUIRED

7.0 Mt

CO₂ PER YEAR FROM
THAT GAS

SOLAR LAND REQUIREMENT, TO SCALE



the pax silica site:
1,619 ha



all of new Clark
city: 9,450 ha



solar land at this
setting: 3,000 ha

This is closest to what the record actually supports. The DFC-funded $\geq 1,200$ MW LNG study is the only firm-generation option currently under study, which is not the same as a committed plan; no energy plan of any kind has been published.

THE REGULATOR'S OWN VERDICT • 27 JULY 2026

"If you put it on the grid, and then suddenly this 3 gigawatt demand will be lost, the grid will just shut down... It's too dangerous for our usual consumers."

ENERGY SECRETARY SHARON GARIN, INTERVIEW WITH RAPPLER, 27 JULY 2026

100–200 MW

THE CEILING THE GRID
CAN ABSORB

3–7%

OF THE PROJECT'S
EVENTUAL DEMAND

1,300 MW

GAP BETWEEN COMMITTED
AND REQUIRED

3–5 yrs

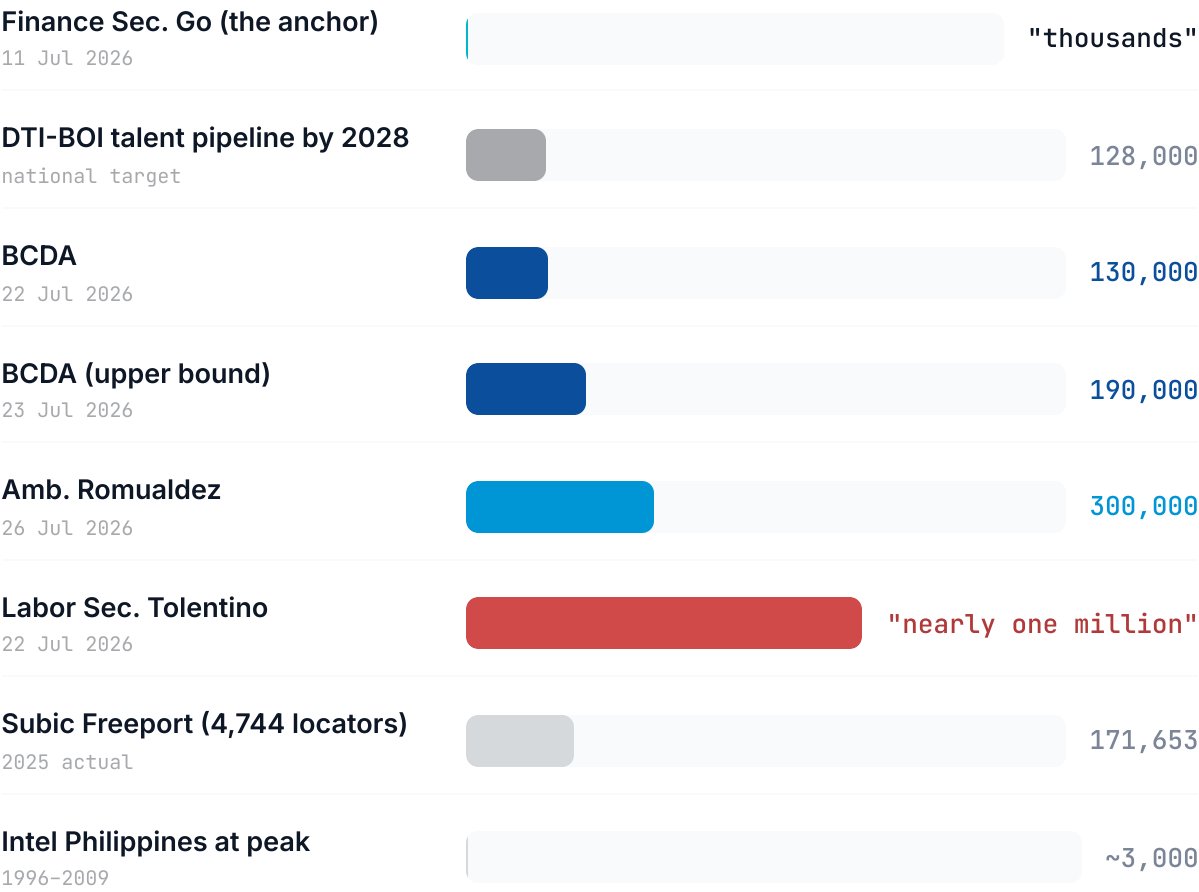
TO BUILD CONVENTIONAL
GENERATION; ABOUT 10
FOR NUCLEAR

Her preferred configuration is a stand-alone system with its own generation, renewable or gas. The interview puts the load at about 19% of Luzon's projected 2026 peak, matching this report's figure by an independent route, and notes it is close to the entire Visayas grid. The 1,300 MW gap is what is left after counting 500 MW of ACWA solar and the proposed 1,200 MW of LNG against the 3,000 MW required. And that is before allowing for the obvious: a 500 MW solar plant does not produce 500 MW at night. The LNG carries a logistics problem of its own: it arrives by ship, but Clark has an airport, not a seaport, so the fuel must land at a coastal terminal and travel inland by a pipeline that does not exist. That is what the unsolicited Subic–Clark fuel-line proposal is for. Set against BCDA's Q1 2028 site-development target, none of these timelines fit. What changes here is not the direction of the finding but its standing: the department that would have to approve grid connection has said publicly that it will not approve it at scale.

Benchmark: BCDA's own signed ACWA Power lease, 500 hectares for up to 500 MW of solar plus storage, i.e. 1 ha per MW of nameplate. Solar at 20% capacity factor. The Department of Energy projects Luzon's 2026 peak demand at 15,600 MW. The highest peak actually recorded by mid-2026 was 14,534 MW. So a 3 GW load is 19.2% of the projection, and 20.6% of the real maximum. On 15 May 2026 the grid ran a 373 MW deficit under red alert with 4,106 MW on forced outage across 30 plants. The US DFC has funded a feasibility study for a ≥1,200 MW LNG terminal and plant at the site.

EXHIBIT 03 · EMPLOYMENT

five figures in fifteen days, no new study

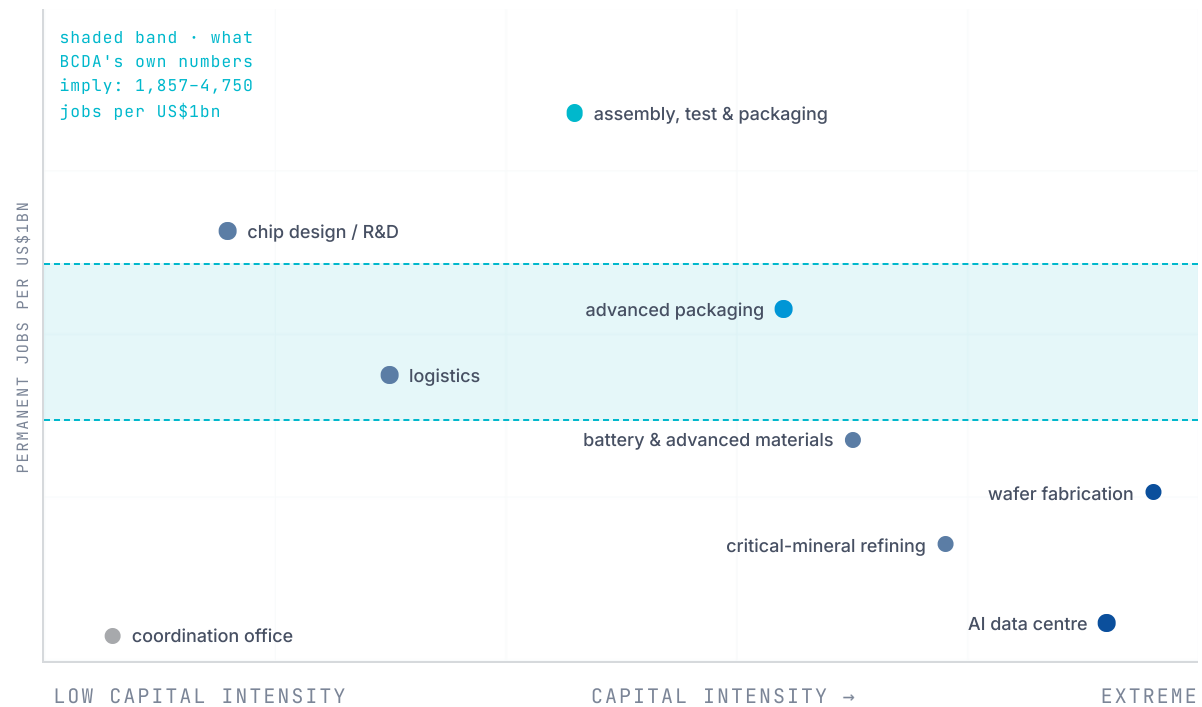


The only bottom-up figure on the record is the Finance Secretary's own "thousands of jobs" from the named anchor. Against it, DTI-BOI's national target is to *produce* 128,000 engineers and technicians

for the whole Philippine semiconductor and electronics industry by 2028, a talent-pipeline target rather than an employment ceiling. BCDA's low-end figure for this single site would consume all of it.

EXHIBIT 04 • THE CENTRAL CONTRADICTION

capital-intensive, or job-intensive. not both.

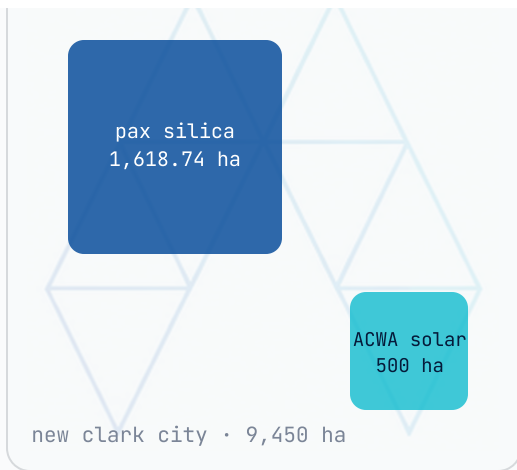


Pairing US\$40–70bn with 130,000–190,000 direct jobs implies 134–196 jobs per developable hectare, a labour-intensive light-manufacturing density. That is assembly, test and packaging, not hyperscale compute and not wafer fabrication. The named anchor's described activity, "computer parts and electronic components manufacturing," sits exactly there.

EXHIBIT 05 • THE PARCEL

1,618.74 ha inside new clark city

EXHIBIT 06 • IMPLEMENTATION



Parcel	1,618.74 ha
Share of New Clark City	17.1%
Municipalities	Capas & Bamban, Tarlac
Rent, years 1–2	PHP 0
Rent from year 3	"To be discussed"
Lease term	Not stated
Annex A map	Referenced, absent

Schematic only. The parcel's metes and bounds have never been published, Annex A of the BCDA letter is referenced in the document and absent from it. Every substantive question about this project is downstream of a map that does not exist publicly.

fifteen of sixteen gates are open

☒	Political declaration signed	16 Apr 2026
☒	Land offered	unilateral offer, 9 Apr 2026
☐	Framework agreement	draft exchanged; target Nov 2026
☐	Supplemental Agreement (boundaries and terms)	does not exist
☐	Parcel legally defined; Annex A published	referenced, absent; FOI request refused 10 Jun 2026
☐	Master plan for the parcel published	none
☐	Project-specific EIS / ECC	DENR: "will be required"
☐	Cumulative impact assessment	none
☐	Water balance study published	none
☐	Water permit / abstraction volume set	NWRB opined without publishing
☐	Grid interconnection study or agreement	none
☐	Lease rate from Year 3 set	"To be discussed"
☐	Lease term set	no term stated

- | | | |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| ☐ | Binding investor commitment | Foxconn a prospect; ~30 letters |
| ☐ | Financing committed | DFC funded a feasibility study only |
| ☐ | Procurement / construction | target Q1 2028 |

EXHIBIT 07 • SCENARIOS

five futures, ranked by likelihood

35%

PLAUSIBLY 25–45%

proceeds, but narrower, slower and less capital-intensive

The most likely single outcome. A framework is signed, but what gets built is a conventional advanced-electronics and logistics park with an assembly-test-and-packaging core, a modest data-centre component, and a coordination office. Perhaps US\$5–15bn over a decade; 15,000–40,000 direct jobs. Economically this is genuinely positive, a good outcome for the Philippines. Politically it is damaging, because the gap will be measured against 190,000 jobs and US\$70bn. This is a good outcome that will be reported as a failure, which is the strongest argument for setting honest expectations now.

TRIGGERS

- Investors decline the power and water risk
- The AI capex cycle cools

EARLY WARNING

- Locator agreements at ordinary industrial scale

The Philippines fails to resolve electricity costs

Foxconn proceeds at ordinary scale, its own described activity points here

Data-centre component scoped down in the master plan

Officials quietly ceasing to repeat the headline figures

EXHIBIT 08 • PRECONDITIONS

is signing warranted yet?

0 OF 7 MET

do not sign

If any one of the seven is unmet, the Philippines should not sign anything binding. A strictly non-binding framework remains available, but only if its text expressly creates no lease, no land right, no entitlement and no funding commitment. None of the seven takes more than a few months, and all are within the executive's control. The only cost of insisting on them is a delayed photograph.

status at 29 july 2026, latest verification: 0 of 7

EXHIBIT 09 • STAKEHOLDERS

who is loud, who is silent

Thirty actors placed by influence against the position they have taken publicly. Circle size is influence. The dashed circles are the finding: four actors central to whether this

project can proceed have said nothing on the record.



 silent on the record  supportive  broadly positive  sceptical  opposed

Click any circle for its position, what it stands to gain, and what it bears.

Four circles sit on the centre line, and they should not be there. NGCP and the ERC own the 3 GW question; the NCIP holds the FPIC process that carries the clearest legal-veto risk; the Senate holds concurrence. Those three sit high on influence and have taken no public position. The fourth, the Tarlac provincial government with the municipalities of Capas and Bamban, sits lower on formal influence but is the host community that would live with the result. Each of these actors is the party that would be blamed if the risk it owns materialises, so silence buys them nothing. The largest single gap in the evidence base for this report is the near-total absence of the local government units from the record.

three layers, one of them published

The lease has three distinct layers and they have been persistently conflated. Only the first is documented. Which structure the second layer takes is, on this report's assessment, the single most consequential undisclosed structural fact in the entire file.

LAYER 1 government to government	Republic of the Philippines, via BCDA, to the United States BCDA letter and the Supplemental Agreement	PUBLISHED
LAYER 2 investor lease	BCDA, or a master lessee, to foreign investors RA 7652 as amended by RA 12252	NOT EXECUTED
LAYER 3 locator operations	PEZA or BCDA to registered business enterprises RA 7916 ecozone registration plus CREATE MORE incentives	NOT EXECUTED

LAYER 2, THE QUESTION NOBODY HAS BEEN ASKED

the united states as master lessee

BCDA leases the whole 1,618.74 hectares to the United States, which then sublets to Foxconn and other locators. A single foreign-government-held property interest over a contiguous block of Philippine territory, financeable, transferable and sublettable for up to 99 years.

One counterparty holds the entire parcel

The lease may be collateralised for long-term financing

Locator selection sits with the lessee, not with a Philippine agency

Reversion is to the Republic, but only at the end of the term

The difference is not technical. The master lease runs 99 years over 1,618.74 hectares, held by a foreign government. It can be sublet to others, and pledged as security for loans. That gives a

foreign state a property interest over one unbroken block of Philippine territory, tradeable and borrowable against, for a century. Thirty direct locator leases granted by a Philippine agency under Philippine law is ordinary ecozone administration. The published documents address only layer 1, and no Philippine official has been asked publicly which of the two is intended.

EXHIBIT 11 · THE SYSTEM THIS BELONGS TO

the chokepoint map

Pax Silica is not a Philippine project with foreign investors. It is the demand-anchoring layer of a deliberate American reorganisation of technology supply chains, and its logic is complementarity, not symmetry: each member holds something the AI ecosystem cannot function without. The question for the Philippines is which of these it is bringing, and what it gets for it.

EUV lithography	Netherlands · ASML	a true monopoly; ~90% of DUV overall100%
CPU architecture	United Kingdom · Arm	of smartphones, though ~87% SoftBank-owned and Nasdaq-listed>99%
Primary low-purity gallium	China	USGS Mineral Commodity Summaries 202598–99%
Rare-earth magnets	China	IEA, 2024 output~94%
Rare-earth refining	China	of refined output, 2024~91%
High-bandwidth memory	South Korea · SK Hynix, Samsung	was ~95% in 2024; Micron's ramp broke the duopoly~80%
Germanium	China	USGS declines to publish a precise share~60%

Assembly, test & packaging

Southeast Asia

the Philippine seat:
electronics are 54% of
national exports

54%

Leading-edge fabrication

Taiwan · TSMC

at the frontier,
which is why
Taiwan endorses
without signing,
through a joint
statement of 27
January 2026
signed by AIT and
TECRO rather
than by Taiwan as
a state

dominant

GPUs, EDA, frontier models, capital

United States

design costs
run US\$42.8m
at 28nm to
~US\$725m
at 2nm

the kernel

STAGE 1 · PROJECT VAULT 2 feb 2026

upstream: stabilising the floor

EXIM board approves a direct loan of up to US\$10bn, the largest in the agency's 92-year history, plus ~US\$2bn of private capital from GE Vernova, Boeing, GM, Western Digital and Clarios, to create the U.S. Strategic Critical Minerals Reserve across all 60 USGS critical minerals. CSIS calls it "a Costco for critical minerals."

STAGE 2 · FORGE

4 feb 2026

midstream: organising the allied market

The Forum on Resource Geostrategic Engagement supersedes the 2022 Minerals Security Partnership, with Korea as first chair. Its distinguishing feature is a preferential trade-and-investment bloc with coordinated price floors, enforced through adjustable tariffs. This is managed trade, stated openly.

STAGE 3 · PAX SILICA 12 dec 2025

downstream: anchoring demand

The declaration network assessed throughout this report, linking secured minerals to AI and semiconductor production inside a protected allied market, "capable of competing with, and ultimately displacing, the

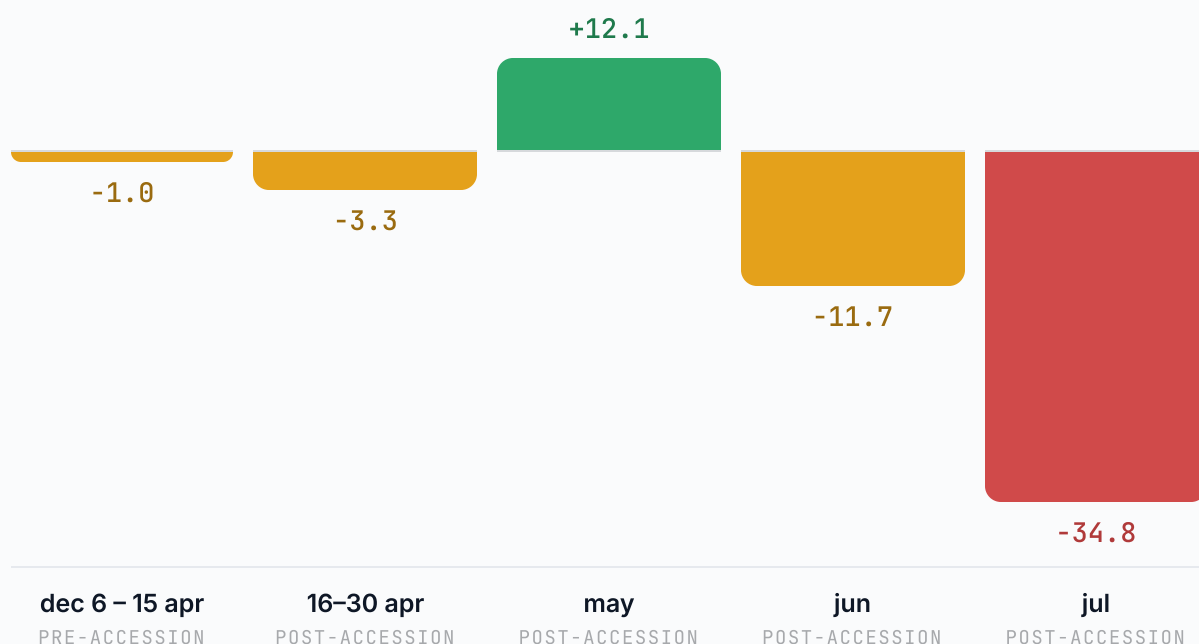
concentrated supply chains on which the world currently depends."

The Philippine connection runs through all three stages, and has been under-appreciated. The 4 February 2026 Ministerial that launched FORGE is the same event at which DENR Secretary Lotilla signed the US–Philippines Critical Minerals MOU. The first listed function of the proposed Coordination Office at New Clark City is "coordination of critical mineral supply chain security initiatives." The Philippines is not merely hosting Stage 3's first Zone, it is simultaneously being enrolled in Stage 1's supply base and Stage 2's price-managed trading bloc. Whether its minerals enter that system as raw ore or as processed value-added product is what the framework will silently determine, and nothing published so far secures the second outcome. Membership is not the prize. Position within the membership is the prize.

EXHIBIT 12 • THE PUBLIC CONVERSATION

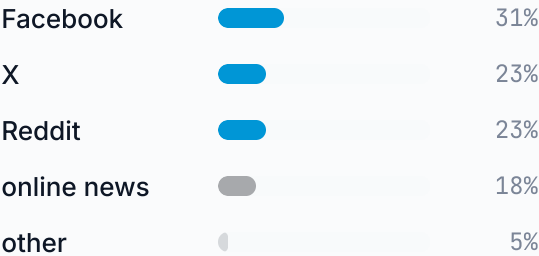
6,437 mentions, december to sona eve

A social listening export covering 6 December 2025 to 27 July 2026: a stated 10% sample of global public mentions, excluding reshares, which puts the universe on the order of 64,000 original posts. Section 17 mapped who the stakeholders are; this measures what they are actually saying.



May's positive spike is the instructive one. It coincides with the government's most defensive month, the public rejection of the US jurisdiction-and-immunity request on 18 May. The Philippine public rewarded the government for saying no. The slide that follows tracks the disclosure vacuum: as official claims escalated through June and July without documents, sentiment worsened in step. July produced 2,927 mentions, 45% of the entire eight-month record, and the final eight days alone carry 36.4% of everything ever said.

WHERE THE CONVERSATION HAPPENS



After 16 April the conversation moved from newsrooms to Filipino social media. 4,151 mentions, of which 46.3% are Philippine-related, a third of it in Filipino. Reddit went from 39 mentions to 943, a 24-fold increase.

THE FIVE BIGGEST DAYS: ALL IN THE LAST EIGHT

24 jul	the BCDA figures blitz, the 99-year-lease disclosure and the US 12.5% tariff land on one news day	621 · -43
26 jul	SONA eve	402 · -25
23 jul	the US\$40–70bn and 190,000-jobs claims	343 · -37
25 jul	peso closes at a record low	335 · -30
22 jul	Secretary Rubio's Manila visit, amid protests	229 · -50

The opposition has minted its own hashtag. **#NoToPaxSilica** appears **50 times against #PaxSilica's 105**, for every two branded mentions, one carries the counter-brand.

WHAT THE CONVERSATION IS ABOUT: VOLUME AGAINST NET SENTIMENT

The structure is the finding: the big topics are contested but balanced. The small ones are one-sided grievances.



Geopolitics & security	1,294 · 20.1%		0.0
Jobs & economy	1,111 · 17.3%		+2.6
Minerals & mining	793 · 12.3%		+2.3
Water & environment	568 · 8.8%		-43.8
Sovereignty & legality	201 · 3.1%		-27.9
Land & indigenous	165 · 2.6%		-50.3
Governance & corruption	79 · 1.2%		-54.4

Software struggles with irony in Filipino and Taglish. In this data it labelled a plainly critical Taglish post as positive. So treat the levels as rough, and read the month-to-month movement instead, as long as the method behind it stays the same. 33.3% of mentions match no topic category and are excluded from topic shares. No TikTok in this export; Facebook is limited to public content. One further note: the single most prolific named author in the dataset is Grok, X's AI assistant, at 50 mentions. AI intermediaries are now answering the Filipino public's questions about Pax Silica in-feed, a channel no government communication plan currently addresses.

CURRENT LISTENING · 1-3 AUGUST 2026

the conversation right now

SENTIMENT TOWARD THE PROJECT

52.6% **29.5%** **14.3%** **3.6%**
 NEGATIVE NEUTRAL POSITIVE MIXED OR UNCLEAR



These labels are applied by software, not by people. Three days is a starting point, not a trend. The percentages cover the posts the software judged to be about this project.

WHERE THE CONVERSATION HAPPENS

WHAT IT IS ABOUT (a post can count in more than one)

Facebook	69.1%	Governance	42.5%
X	11.5%	Environment	21.9%
Reddit	10.1%	Indigenous rights	15.8%
News	4.5%	Investment	15.2%
YouTube	3.5%	Sovereignty	10.5%
everything else	1.3%	no category matched	37.8%

WHO IS SPEAKING

Private individuals	83.5%
Media	6.6%
Government	6.3%
Civil society	2.1%
Faith-based	1.0%
Business	0.5%

Government accounts for 6.3% of the conversation and business for 0.5%. The central open question is what the Philippine state has actually committed to. Yet almost all the public discussion is coming from private individuals, not from the institutions that would have to sign.

source · social listening export, query "pax silica" OR hashtags:paxsilica, English and Tagalog, worldwide, reposts excluded · window 1-3 August 2026
method · every post in the window was labelled by software and none of it was reviewed by a person · a post can fall under more than one topic, so those figures add to more than 100% · three days is not a trend

04

claim checker

Exhibit 13. Every public claim located in the record, with its claimant, its status, and the evidence that contradicts it. Filter by status or by who said it.

VERIFIED

SCOPE

Project area is 4,000 acres (1,618.74 ha)

US State Dept · BCDA

Verified as a stated figure. $4,000 \text{ ac} \times 0.404686 = 1,618.74 \text{ ha}$.

PARTIAL

SCOPE

Area equals 1,600 / 1,618 / 1,619 / 1,620 ha

Various

All are roundings of one US-stated acreage, not an independent Philippine survey.

FALSE

SCOPE

The parcel boundaries are defined

no claimant, assessed finding

The BCDA letter says boundaries "shall be determined by mutual agreement... set forth in a Supplemental Agreement". Annex A maps are referenced and absent from the published PDF.

FALSE

SCOPE

The site is at the former Clark Air Base, Pampanga

Local and international outlets

New Clark City is in Capas and Bamban, Tarlac. A recurring media error.

UNKNOWN

SCOPE

"First AI-native industrial acceleration hub"

US State Dept · Helberg

An official designation with undefined content. Neither government has published a technical definition of "AI-native".

VERIFIED

SCOPE

The site is 17.1% of New Clark City

Derived

1,618.74 ÷ 9,450 ha. Verified arithmetic.

PROJECTION

MONEY

US\$40–70bn of investment at full development

BCDA (Bingcang)

"Based on scientific studies, not speculation." The studies are unpublished and no investor is bound.

PROJECTION

MONEY

Initial investment requirement of US\$10bn

BCDA

Funding source unstated, public, private, or which party.

VERIFIED

MONEY

Around 30 firms have expressed interest

BCDA

Verified as a statement of interest, not of commitment. None is named; BCDA says "we cannot entertain them yet fully".

UNVERIFIED

MONEY

50+ firms including "trillion-dollar tech giants"

Reported

Inconsistent with BCDA's own figure of around 30.

PROJECTION

MONEY

Foxconn will anchor the hub

Finance Sec. Frederick Go

A named prospect, not a commitment. Go: "if Foxconn proceeds"; nothing is signed.

PROJECTION

JOBS

Foxconn would invest billions and generate "thousands of jobs"

Finance Sec. Go

Internally revealing: "thousands" is one and a half to two orders of magnitude below the 130,000–190,000 aggregate claim.

VERIFIED

SCOPE

The project is still at the planning stage and it is premature to release official information

BCDA

BCDA's own words, refusing a Freedom of Information request for the project pipeline on 12 May 2026 under the pre-decisional and premature-disclosure exceptions. A second denial on 10 June 2026 withheld the site map. Tier-1 confirmation, by the proponent, that the project is pre-decisional and that the Annex A vacuum is deliberate.

FALSE

MONEY

A binding investment commitment exists

no claimant, assessed finding

None found as at the latest verification. BCDA states the framework must be finalised first.

UNVERIFIED

MONEY

AWS is discussing a US\$5bn regional investment

Reported

Not corroborated; regional, not site-specific.

PROJECTION

JOBS

Over 130,000 high-quality jobs

BCDA

Official projection, 22 Jul 2026.

PROJECTION

JOBS

130,000–190,000 direct and 500,000–800,000 indirect jobs

BCDA (Bingcang)

The indirect figure implies multipliers of 3.8×–4.2×, at the high end of published ranges for enclave manufacturing. The multiplier and its source are undisclosed.

PROJECTION

JOBS

"Nearly one million jobs"

Labor Sec. Francis Tolentino

Basis given as a comparison to "Taiwan's industrial growth model". No labour standards, wage scales or training commitments stated.

PROJECTION

JOBS

Up to 300,000 jobs "as early as 2027"

Amb. Jose Manuel Romualdez

Timeframe irreconcilable with BCDA's own Q1 2028 construction start.

UNVERIFIED

JOBS

"Endless jobs"

US Amb. Lee Lipton

Stakeholder claim.

PROJECTION

FISCAL

PHP 180bn/yr in total government income at full operation

BCDA

Composition unpublished.

MISLEADING

FISCAL

PHP 68–75bn/yr in withholding tax

BCDA

BCDA specified the composition at the Palace briefing of 23 July 2026: tax contributed by the workers, i.e. payroll withholding. That forecloses the non-payroll explanation. It implies average worker compensation of about PHP 2.13m, 2.4× a Philippine semiconductor engineer (PHP 870,938) and 8.1× an operator (PHP 263,118). One of the two headline figures, the tax or the employment, is therefore materially overstated.

PROJECTION

FISCAL

PHP 60bn in lease income over 25 years

BCDA

Equals PHP 148.26/m²/yr. Present value at 8% real is about PHP 25.6bn, or 0.59%–1.03% of the projected investment. No independent land valuation has been published.

MISLEADING

FISCAL

US\$200bn of exports at full build-out

BCDA

2.37× the Philippines' entire 2025 merchandise exports of US\$84.48bn, 4.36× total electronics exports and 5.78× total semiconductor exports of US\$34.62bn.

PROJECTION

FISCAL

"About 10% of GDP"

BCDA

The domestic value-added assumption reconciling this with US\$200bn of gross exports is unpublished, and it is the single most important number in any value-chain argument. Philippine electronics has historically captured a modest slice of gross flows because it imports most inputs and performs a narrow part of the process. JC Punongbayan of the UP School of Economics warns of exactly that outcome: the Philippines supplying "the land, minerals, power, water, and low-cost labor" while technology, patents, profits and strategic control remain abroad.

UNKNOWN

FISCAL

The cost of the fiscal incentive package

no claimant, assessed finding

No published estimate. CREATE MORE provides 5% SCIT or 20% CIT with enhanced deductions including a 100% additional deduction on power expenses, for up to 17–27 years. A material omission.

PROJECTION

WATER & POWER

Water demand 65–90 MLD; design capacity 120 MLD, expandable to as much as 300 MLD

BCDA

Technically unsubstantiated. No water balance has been published. The 300 MLD expansion path, described at the 23 July Palace briefing, scales the required catchment to roughly 4,900–10,400 hectares, which is three to six times the entire parcel.

MISLEADING

WATER & POWER

Water comes from rainwater harvesting, not community supply

BCDA

The required catchment is 90–193% of the site, so at 90 MLD this is watershed water rather than site water. Stated precisely: the on-parcel framing fails at the upper end of BCDA's own demand estimate; what the appropriation does to downstream users is undetermined pending a catchment-level water balance, and the burden of proof sits with the proponent.

UNVERIFIED

WATER & POWER

Water within the project area is sufficient

NWRB Exec. Dir. Sevilla D. David Jr.

No technical data, model or independent verification published.

PROJECTION

WATER & POWER

Energy demand of about 3 GW at full development

BCDA

Independent technical commentary cites 5+ GW. Against the DOE's official projection of 15,600 MW for 2026 Luzon peak demand, 3 GW is 19.2%; against the 14,534 MW actually recorded by mid-2026, it is 20.6%.

MISLEADING

WATER & POWER

Power will be renewable; the project aims to avoid fossil fuels

BCDA

The US DFC is funding a feasibility study for a $\geq 1,200$ MW LNG terminal and plant at the site. Solar equivalent to 3 GW would need about 15,000 ha, which is 9.3 $\times$ the parcel.

MISLEADING

WATER & POWER

The project "will not cut into current power supplies in the area"

BCDA

True if and only if 3 GW of net-new firm capacity is commissioned before the load energises. Presented as unconditional.

PARTIAL

WATER & POWER

40% of the site is reserved as open or green space

BCDA • NCC master plan

Applies to the NCC master plan generally; not shown to bind the Pax Silica parcel, and incompatible with maximal rainwater capture.

PARTIAL

ENVIRONMENT

All investments require an Environmental Compliance Certificate

BCDA • DENR

Overstated as put, correct in effect. ECCs attach to Category A and B projects, not to all investments (DAO 2003-30 §§4.1, 4.4, 4.6; a Certificate of Non-Coverage covers Category D). But the estate far exceeds the 25-hectare Category B threshold for industrial parks under EMB MC 2014-005 §3.6.6, so it unambiguously requires an ECC with a full EIS. None is on the public record, and no cumulative impact assessment exists.

VERIFIED

ENVIRONMENT

There will be no mining inside the project area

BCDA

Verified as to extraction on site; incomplete as to consequences. The US fact sheet cites "enhanced access to the Philippines'... mineral endowments" and refining is a listed on-site activity.

MISLEADING

ENVIRONMENT

Pax Silica will drive rare-earth and nickel plunder

Kalikasan PNE • AGHAM • CPU • KMP

Substantially overstated as applied to semiconductors. Silicon is ~95% of semiconductor material demand and the Philippines is not a silicon producer; per-mineral end uses: nickel is ~65–70% stainless steel with batteries ~10–15% and rising; cobalt was 76% lithium-ion batteries in 2024, of which EVs ~43% and portable electronics ~30%, with stainless nil; chromite is ~90–96% metallurgical and ferrochrome, over 80% of that to stainless. Semiconductor demand for these minerals is negligible, confirmed against USGS, INSG, Cobalt Institute and ICDA breakdowns. A narrower minerals concern survives.

MISLEADING

ENVIRONMENT

Data centres will cause light pollution disrupting wildlife

Advocacy groups

Substantially overstated, but a legitimate and mitigable EIA screening item. Data centre interiors are essentially unlit; exterior lighting is not. 24/7 perimeter security, parking, roads and the construction

phase are a documented ecological disruptor per US DOE Solid-State Lighting guidance and DarkSky International's statement specifically on data-centre light pollution, and readily mitigated with full-cutoff fixtures, lamps at 3000K or below, and curfew dimming. Campaigners would be better served narrowing this point than dropping it.

UNVERIFIED

LEGAL & SOCIAL

Clark Freeport exceeds 30,000 ha, of which 15,000+ ha are already allocated to indigenous groups

BCDA

Offered by BCDA in support of its no-displacement position. Not independently verified in this review, and it concerns the wider Clark Freeport rather than the Pax Silica parcel.

DISPUTED

LEGAL & SOCIAL

No indigenous community will be displaced

BCDA • Malacañang

Turns on titled versus claimed domain. Aeta CADT applications over Capas were filed in 1999, 2014 and May 2019. Under IPRA, native title and FPIC obligations do not depend on a CADT having issued. Section 59 goes further: it bars any government agency or government-owned corporation from issuing a lease or concession without NCIP certification that the area is not overlapped, and its proviso covers pending applications, so a new BCDA lease would be barred outright if the parcel overlaps the Aeta claims filed in 1999, 2014 and 2019.

DISPUTED

LEGAL & SOCIAL

Only about 10 farmers are affected

BCDA

Campaigners cite ~20,000 Aeta and farmers; historical NCC-wide figures cite 65,000 people in 12 villages including ~18,000 Aeta. Unresolvable without Annex A.

VERIFIED

LEGAL & SOCIAL

A two-year rent-free grace period is offered

BCDA letter

"Years 1–2 (Grace Period), In-kind Contribution of the Philippines." Worth roughly PHP 4.8bn at the rent implied by BCDA's own figures.

UNKNOWN

LEGAL & SOCIAL

The Year-3 lease rate

BCDA letter

Verified that it is undetermined. The published table reads "To be discussed."

UNKNOWN

LEGAL & SOCIAL

The lease term

BCDA letter

No term is stated anywhere in the document. BCDA separately cites the 99-year ceiling under RA 12252.

PARTIAL

LEGAL & SOCIAL

Investors may lease for up to 99 years under RA 12252

BCDA

Verified as to the law, unverified as to this project, and narrower than the citation implies. The 99-year regime under RA 7652 as amended covers private lands leased by registered foreign investors. New Clark City is state land, which raises a threshold question about whether the regime applies at all, and it confers no authority for a master lease to a foreign government.

DISPUTED

LEGAL & SOCIAL

The US sought diplomatic immunity and US jurisdiction

BCDA (Bingcang)

Helberg: "We never said our goal was to maintain diplomatic immunity... patently untrue." The State Department declined to answer the direct question on 26 May 2026.

The project is purely commercial, with no defence function

Helberg · BCDA

Not sustainable as stated. Amb. Romualdez links Pax Silica revenue to the country becoming "more militarily equipped"; the US fact sheet frames the network as displacing rival supply chains. No dual-use exclusion clause is published.

Pax Silica has 25 signatories

US State Dept

CORRECTION, 1 Aug 2026 — this site previously published "24 signatories" as verified. That was accurate when checked on 26 June 2026; Italy signed the Declaration at Brindisi on 31 July 2026 as the 25th signatory, and the count is now 25. Still widely miscounted as 13, 14, 15, 23 or "about 30". One signatory, the EU, is not a country. Saudi Arabia has been wrongly listed.

"More than 30 countries" have joined Pax Silica

BCDA · Palace briefing, 23 Jul 2026

Stated twice to national media. The State Department count on that date was 24 signatories, unchanged since the Second Summit four weeks earlier, and one of the 24 is the EU rather than a country. The 35-economy figure belongs to the separate Joint Statement on AI Opportunity. An overstatement of roughly 25%, uncorrected.

Pax Silica is "23-member strong"

President Marcos · State of the Nation Address, 27 Jul 2026

Stated in the annual address to Congress. The State Department count that day was 24. The figure is not random: the State Department's own Pax Silica page lists 23 signatories and omits the United States from its own roster, so counting the page yields 23. Two outlets repeated it within the week. The same government produced an overstatement of roughly 25% and an understatement of one within four days, neither corrected publicly.

A framework will be signed in November 2026 at the ASEAN Summit

BCDA

Other statements point to 2027 finalisation; Finance Sec. Go says "within the year".

The USTR imposed a 12.5% forced-labour tariff on Philippine exports

Office of the US Trade Representative

Published 23 July and effective 24 July 2026, finding the Philippines "has failed to impose and effectively enforce a forced-labor import prohibition." Verified against the Federal Register notice, the measure carries exemptions, semiconductors and other Section 232-covered articles, donations, informational materials, and an excluded-products annex expanded by 471 HTS subheadings, and it replaced a Section 122 surcharge of 10%, documented to Federal Register doc. 2026-03824, which expired at the same minute the new action began. For goods covered by both, the net increment is roughly +2.5 percentage points. For the exempt goods, which include semiconductors, coconuts, pineapples, bananas and nickel ores, the change was a decrease of about 10 points. The signal stands even as the magnitude shrinks.

51 OF 51 CLAIMS SHOWN

05 — the full assessment

Twenty-nine sections. Each opens in place; the complete report downloads as a PDF.

[download the full report · pdf ↓](#)

06 — sources register

Every source this assessment relies on, numbered and tiered, so any finding can be traced back to what it rests on. Each report section lists the register IDs it

draws on; each claim in the checker links here.

59 REGISTERED SOURCES · 13 REFERENCED BUT ABSENT

tier 1 · primary and authoritative 21 ENTRIES

Official texts, published documents, statutes, statistical releases and FOI responses. Treated as evidence of what was said or recorded, not of whether it is true.

T1-01

DEC 2025 TO PRESENT

Pax Silica Declaration, full text and signatory list

US Department of State

The founding instrument and its 25 signatories.

www.state.gov →

T1-02

16 APR 2026

Media Note: US and Philippines launch plans for a 4,000-acre Economic Security Zone

US Department of State

Origin of the 4,000-acre figure and the "first AI-native industrial acceleration hub" designation.

www.state.gov →

T1-03

16 APR 2026

Fact Sheet: Economic Security Zone

US Department of State and Embassy Manila

Contains the "joint governance" and "fuse American expertise in institutions and legal regimes" language.

ph.usembassy.gov →

T1-04

16 APR 2026

Media Note as republished by Embassy Manila

US Embassy Manila

ph.usembassy.gov →

T1-05

9 APR 2026 LETTER, 16 APR 2026 NOTE VERBALE

Note Verbale JMGR-NV-145-2026 with the BCDA proposal letter

PH Embassy Washington and Board of Investments

Four pages, signature redacted. Annex A is absent from the published version. The operative text behind most scope, term and rent questions.

boi.gov.ph →

T1-06

26 JUN 2026

Outcomes of the Second Pax Silica Summit

US Department of State

Does not mention the Philippine Zone.

www.state.gov →

T1-07

20 APR 2026

BCDA announcement: New Clark City to serve as AI hub

BCDA

www.bcda.gov.ph →

T1-08

2026

Fact Sheet: Luzon Economic Corridor

US Embassy Manila

ph.usembassy.gov →

T1-09

11 MAY 2026

Luzon Economic Corridor partnership expansion

US Embassy Manila and Embassy of Japan

ph.usembassy.gov →

T1-10

4 FEB 2026

PH and US critical minerals MOU announcement

PH Embassy Washington

philippineembassy-dc.org →

T1-11

FEB 2026

2026 Critical Minerals Ministerial

US Department of State

www.state.gov →

T1-12

1992

RA 7227, Bases Conversion and Development Act of 1992

Congress and BCDA

The actual BCDA charter.

www.bcdagov.ph →

T1-13

24 MAR 1992

RA 7277, Magna Carta for Disabled Persons

Official Gazette

The statute miscited in the BCDA letter as the BCDA charter.

www.officialgazette.gov.ph →

T1-14

REQUESTED 6 MAY 2026, DENIED 12 MAY 2026

BCDA FOI denial: Pax Silica project pipeline

eFOI portal, tracking BCDA-709787348964

Source of "the project is still on the planning stage and it is premature for BCDA to release any official information".

www.foi.gov.ph →

T1-15

REQUESTED 8 JUN 2026, ANSWERED 10 JUN 2026

BCDA FOI denial: Pax Silica hub site map

eFOI portal, tracking BCDA-462421872795

Map withheld; the 1,619-hectare site is confirmed.

www.foi.gov.ph →

T1-16

PROCLAIMED 20 FEB 2026, EXPIRED 24 JUL 2026

Section 122 temporary import surcharge of 10%

Federal Register document 2026-03824

The predecessor of the July tariff action, and the reason the net change is 10 points down rather than 12.5 up.

www.federalregister.gov →

T1-17

26 MAR 2026

International Merchandise Trade Statistics 2025, final

Philippine Statistics Authority

Exports US\$84.48bn, electronics US\$45.89bn.

psa.gov.ph →

T1-18

Jacob Helberg biography

US Department of State

www.state.gov →

T1-19

FEB 2026

2025 Philippine Trade in Goods

Congressional Policy and Budget Research Department

cpbrd.congress.gov.ph →

T1-20

2022 EDITION

The Mineral Industry of the Philippines

USGS Minerals Yearbook

Used to test the resource-plunder critique against production data.

pubs.usgs.gov →

T1-21

20 APR 2021

Renegotiated Foxconn contract announcement

Office of the Governor of Wisconsin

Primary record of the announced-versus-delivered gap with the same counterparty.

content.govdelivery.com →

tier 2 · high-quality analytical

6 ENTRIES

Named specialists and research institutions with disclosed method. Used for benchmarks and interpretation.

T2-01

12 JUN 2026

The Philippines has a golden chance to get Pax Silica right

Lowy Institute, Alvin Camba

www.lowyinstitute.org →

T2-02

2026

In this economy: risks of Pax Silica

JC Punongbayan, UP School of Economics, in Rappler

www.rappler.com →

T2-03

2025 TO 2026

Philippine electronics export performance

SEIPI

Industry baseline for export and value-added comparisons.

seipi.org.ph →

T2-04

2026

Philippine power supply for Q2 2026 remains sufficient but thin reserves leave the grid at risk

Institute for Climate and Sustainable Cities

Grid adequacy baseline.

icsc.ngo →

T2-05

25 JUL 2026

Glass house: evaluating criticisms over PH participation in Pax Silica

Pierre Tito Galla, Newsbytes.ph

Source of the "human first, machine last" safeguard proposal.

newsbytes.ph →

T2-06

13 DEC 2019

The New Clark City: a government sell-out of IP and peasant land for private interests

IBON International

Prior record of New Clark City land conflict.

iboninternational.org →

tier 3 · credible journalism 24 ENTRIES

Established Philippine and international outlets. Used for statements attributed to officials and for dated events.

T3-01

26 MAY 2026

US official says immunity for the Clark hub was taken out of context

Philstar

www.philstar.com →

T3-02

19 MAY 2026

Philippines rejects US request for diplomatic immunity at the planned AI hub

Philstar

www.philstar.com →

T3-03

24 JUL 2026

Pax Silica investors may lease New Clark land for 99 years

Philstar

Primary reporting on lease term, rent and the PHP 60bn projection.

www.philstar.com →

T3-04

24 JUL 2026

BCDA: over 30 firms interested in Pax Silica

Philstar

www.philstar.com →

T3-05

11 JUL 2026

Pax Silica gains pace as the US and Philippines push the AI hub

Philstar

Foxconn and Ambassador Lipton statements.

www.philstar.com →

T3-06

16 JUL 2026

PHL and US finalise draft framework for the Pax Silica AI hub

BusinessWorld

Draft framework, DFC LNG feasibility study and Stanford MOU.

bworldonline.com →

T3-07

24 JUL 2026

Trump imposes 12.5% forced-labour tariff on Philippine exports

BusinessWorld

bworldonline.com →

T3-08

JUL 2026

Myths vs facts: BCDA allays fears on the Pax Silica project

Inquirer

newsinfo.inquirer.net →

T3-09

JUL 2026

Pax Silica hub to bring PHP 180 billion in government income and 190,000 jobs, BCDA

Inquirer

Source of the headline revenue and employment figures.

newsinfo.inquirer.net →

T3-10

JUL 2026

SBMA sees revenue and jobs boost with Pax Silica

Inquirer

newsinfo.inquirer.net →

T3-11

JUL 2026

Pangasinan environmental groups join opposition to Pax Silica

Inquirer

newsinfo.inquirer.net →

T3-12

JUL 2026

Pax Silica AI hub to consume 3 gigawatts at full development, BCDA

GMA

Source of the 3,000 MW load figure.

www.gmanetwork.com →

T3-13

JUL 2026

Explainer: Pax Silica, why are people worried

GMA

www.gmanetwork.com →

T3-14

JUL 2026

Things to know about Pax Silica: Philippine goals and concerns

Rappler

www.rappler.com →

T3-15

JUL 2026

STOP US War coalition on resource plunder criticism

Rappler

www.rappler.com →

T3-16

20 JUL 2026

DENR assesses Pax Silica environmental impact

BusinessMirror

businessmirror.com.ph →

T3-17

22 JUL 2026

Local water source enough to supply Pax Silica operation, water board

BusinessMirror

The NWRB position tested in the water section.

businessmirror.com.ph →

T3-18

19 JUL 2026

Scientists, environmentalists and farmers hit the Pax Silica AI hub

Manila Times

Record of the 13 July protest at the US Embassy.

www.manilatimes.net →

T3-19

22 JUL 2026

Labour chief backs Pax Silica, eyes nearly one million jobs

Manila Times

www.manilatimes.net →

T3-20

7 JUL 2026

Foxconn to anchor the first US-led Pax Silica tech hub in Clark

Manila Bulletin

mb.com.ph →

T3-21

24 JUL 2026

Peso hits an all-time low of 61.84 per US dollar

Manila Bulletin

The exchange rate used throughout this report.

mb.com.ph →

T3-22

25 JUL 2026

Inside Pax Silica: the project that could reshape the Philippines

Daily Tribune

tribune.net.ph →

T3-23

26 JUL 2026

Pax Silica could generate up to 300,000 jobs, PH envoy to the US

Daily Tribune

tribune.net.ph →

T3-24

JUL 2026

iPhone maker Foxconn to anchor tech city in the Philippines

Gulf News

gulfnnews.com →

tier 4 · stakeholder claims 8 ENTRIES

Government, embassy, corporate and advocacy positions. Used only as evidence of position.

T4-01

APR TO JUL 2026

BCDA, DOF, DOLE, Malacanang and embassy statements

Philippine government and US Embassy

Used only as evidence of position, never as evidence of fact.

T4-02

2026

Under Secretary Jacob Helberg posts on X

US Department of State official, personal account

Used only as evidence of the US framing.

T4-03

2026

Akbayan to Congress: probe Pax Silica, protect national interest

Akbayan Party

www.akbayan.org.ph →

T4-04

19 JUN 2026

Makabayan bloc position and House Resolution 1128

House of Representatives members

Full resolution text not publicly posted at the cutoff.

T4-05

JUL 2026

KMP, Kalikasan PNE, AGHAM and Computer Professionals Union statements

STOP US War coalition members

Source of the resource-plunder and watershed critiques.

T4-06

JUL 2026

Propel and International League of Peoples Struggles statements

Advocacy organisations

T4-07

JUL 2026

Philippine Chamber of Commerce and Industry statements

PCCI

T4-08

2026

paxsilicaph.org

Wolf Equity, a private publisher

Expressly disclaims official status. Cited as an illustration of an information vacuum being filled by unofficial actors, not as a source of fact.

paxsilicaph.org →

referenced but not published 13 DOCUMENTS REFERENCED BUT NOT PUBLISHED

These are cited by the parties or required by the analysis, but are not in the public record as at the latest verification. They are listed so a reader can see exactly where the evidence stops.

A-01 BCDA, DFA, US STATE DEPT

Annex A, maps of the proposed 4,000-acre site

Defines the parcel. Every environmental, social, valuation and displacement question depends on it.

A-02 BCDA

Supplemental Agreement on boundaries, legal description and operating terms

Would fix location, term and rent. Not yet executed.

A-03 BCDA, DTI, US STATE DEPT

Framework agreement, the draft arrangement in exchange since 16 Jul 2026 or earlier

The operative instrument, target signature November 2026.

A-04 BCDA

The scientific studies behind the US\$40 to 70bn, jobs, tax and export figures

The entire economic case rests on these.

A-05 BCDA

Water balance and impounding dam design

The binding physical constraint.

A-06 BCDA, DOE, NGCP

Grid interconnection and adequacy study

The second binding constraint.

A-07 DOF, BOI, PEZA

Tax-expenditure estimate for the incentive package

The missing half of the fiscal ledger.

A-08 US DFC

DFC feasibility study, LNG terminal and at least 1,200 MW plant

The actual energy plan.

A-09 HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

House Resolution 1128, full text

The scope of congressional inquiry.

A-10 DOW JONES

Wall Street Journal report on US jurisdiction

The origin of the immunity dispute.

A-11 NCIP

NCIP records on Aeta CADT applications over Capas, 1999, 2014 and May 2019

Determines FPIC obligations.

A-12 DENR-EMB

New Clark City master-plan ECC, 2017

Establishes what is and is not already covered. BCDA confirmed on 23 July 2026 that this general certificate, obtained with the 2017 master plan, is the only ECC covering the site, with individual locator ECCs to follow, and that the DENR assessment need not conclude before the November signing. It predates the Pax Silica concept and cannot have assessed a 3 GW load or 65-90 MLD of abstraction.

A-13 OFFICE OF THE PRESIDENT, NEDA

Cabinet and NEDA Board records on the Philippine position

Whether the Republic formally deliberated.

What we deliberately did not count as evidence: search-result pages, AI-written summaries, sites that republish without naming a source, and press releases reprinted elsewhere and then counted as independent confirmation. Wikipedia was used only to cross-check dates, and several of its details conflicted with State Department originals.

appendices

Every calculation, every inconsistent figure, and the operative wording of the BCDA letter, so a reader can check the arithmetic rather than take it on trust. Appendices A and E, the documents register and sources by tier, are in the [sources register](#).

All calculations use published figures; assumptions are stated. Exchange rate throughout: PHP 61.85 = US\$1, 24 July 2026.

B.1 AREA

QUANTITY	FORMULA	RESULT
Site area	$4,000\text{ ac} \times 0.404686\text{ ha/ac}$	1,618.74 ha
Site as share of New Clark City	$1,618.74 \div 9,450$	17.1%
Developable area (net of 40% open space)	$1,618.74 \times 0.60$	971.24 ha
Site in square metres	$1,618.74 \times 10,000$	16,187,400 m ²

B.2 INVESTMENT AND EMPLOYMENT

QUANTITY	FORMULA	RESULT
Investment per ha	$\text{US\$40–70bn} \div 1,618.74$	US\$24.7m – US\$43.2m/ha
Investment per ha (PHP)	$\times 61.85$	PHP 1.53bn – 2.67bn/ha
Capital per direct job (low)	$\text{US\$40bn} \div 190,000$	US\$210,526
Capital per direct job (high)	$\text{US\$70bn} \div 130,000$	US\$538,462
Direct jobs per ha	$130,000\text{--}190,000 \div 1,618.74$	80.3 – 117.4
Direct jobs per developable ha	$\div 971.24$	133.9 – 195.6
Implied employment multiplier	$500,000\text{--}800,000 \div 130,000\text{--}190,000$	3.8 $\times$ – 4.2 $\times$
Foxconn-scale locators needed for 160,000 jobs (at 3,000–5,000 jobs each)	$160,000 \div 3,000\text{--}5,000$	32 – 53 anchor-scale locators

B.3 WATER

QUANTITY	FORMULA	RESULT
Annual volume at 90 MLD	$90,000 \text{ m}^3/\text{d} \times 365$	32.85 million m^3/yr
Annual volume at 65 MLD	$65,000 \text{ m}^3/\text{d} \times 365$	23.73 million m^3/yr
Population-equivalent (domestic use)	$90,000 \text{ m}^3/\text{d} \div (100\text{--}150 \text{ L/cap/d})$	600,000 – 900,000 people
Catchment required	$A = V \div (R \times C)$	1,460 – 3,129 ha (see §12.1.3)
Catchment as % of site	$\div 1,618.74$	90% – 193%
Dry-season storage (180 days)	$65\text{--}90 \text{ MLD} \times 180$	11.7 – 16.2 million m^3
Indirect + direct water at 1.2 gal/kWh for 3 GW continuous	$26.28\text{bn kWh} \times 1.2 \text{ gal} \div 264.17 \text{ gal}/\text{m}^3 \div 365$	$\approx 327 \text{ MLD}$ ($\approx 3.6\times$ the disclosed figure)
Single advanced fab raw-water demand	$2\text{--}10\text{m gal}/\text{d UPW} \times \sim 1.5 \text{ raw:UPW} \div 264.17$	$\approx 11\text{--}57 \text{ MLD}$

B.4 ENERGY

QUANTITY	FORMULA	RESULT
Project demand as % of Luzon peak	$3,000 \div 15,600$ (DOE 2026 projection) $\cdot 3,000 \div 14,534$ (actual max by mid-2026)	19.2% / 20.6%
Annual energy at 100% load factor	$3,000 \text{ MW} \times 8,760 \text{ h}$	26,280 GWh (26.28 TWh)
Solar nameplate needed for that energy at 20% CF	$26,280,000 \text{ MWh} \div 1,752 \text{ MWh/MW}$	$\approx 15,000 \text{ MW}$
Land required at ACWA benchmark (500 ha per 500 MW = 1 ha/MW)	$15,000 \text{ MW} \times 1 \text{ ha/MW}$	$\approx 15,000 \text{ ha}$
As multiple of the Pax Silica site	$15,000 \div 1,618.74$	9.3×
As multiple of all New Clark City	$15,000 \div 9,450$	1.59×
Existing ACWA solar as share of demand (energy basis)	$500 \text{ MW} \times 0.19 \text{ CF} \div 3,000 \text{ MW}$	$\approx 3.2\%$
DFC LNG plant as share of demand	$1,200 \div 3,000$	40%
Indicative generation capex for 3,000 MW firm	$3,000 \text{ MW} \times \text{US\$}1.0\text{--}1.5\text{m/MW}$	US\$3.0 – 4.5bn
Indicative annual power bill at 15 US¢/kWh, 100% LF	$26.28\text{bn kWh} \times \text{US\$}0.15$	$\approx \text{US\$}3.9\text{bn/yr}$

B.5 FISCAL

QUANTITY	FORMULA	RESULT
Annual lease income	PHP 60bn ÷ 25	PHP 2.4bn/yr = US\$38.8m/yr
Lease per ha per year	PHP 2.4bn ÷ 1,618.74	PHP 1,482,635
Lease per m ² per year	÷ 10,000	PHP 148.26
Lease per m ² per month	÷ 12	PHP 12.36
NPV of lease, 8% real, 25 yr (annuity factor 10.675)	PHP 2.4bn × 10.675	PHP 25.62bn ≈ US\$414m
NPV as share of investment	US\$414m ÷ US\$40–70bn	0.59% – 1.03%
Value of 2-year rent grace at implied rate	PHP 2.4bn × 2	≈PHP 4.8bn (US\$77.6m)
Implied aggregate payroll from PHP 68bn tax at 20% effective rate	PHP 68bn ÷ 0.20	PHP 340bn
Implied average annual compensation (160,000 jobs)	PHP 340bn ÷ 160,000	PHP 2,125,000 (US\$34,357)
Same at 10% effective rate	PHP 68bn ÷ 0.10 ÷ 160,000	PHP 4,250,000
Ratio to PH semiconductor engineer average (PHP 870,938)	2,125,000 ÷ 870,938	2.44×
Ratio to PH semiconductor operator average (PHP 263,118)	2,125,000 ÷ 263,118	8.08×
Ratio to PSA average wage (PHP 21,544/mo = PHP 258,528/yr)	2,125,000 ÷ 258,528	8.22×

B.6 EXPORTS

QUANTITY	FORMULA	RESULT
Claim vs total 2025 PH merchandise exports	US\$200bn ÷ US\$84.48bn (PSA final)	2.37×
Claim vs 2025 electronics exports	US\$200bn ÷ US\$45.89bn (PSA final)	4.36×
Claim vs 2025 semiconductor exports	US\$200bn ÷ US\$34.62bn	5.78×

B.7 COMPARATOR: FOXCONN WISCONSIN - ANNOUNCED, RENEGOTIATED, VERIFIED

METRIC	ANNOUNCED (2017)	RENEGOTIATED TARGET (2021, BY END-2025)	WEDC-VER
Investment	US\$10.0bn	US\$672m	~US\$717m
Jobs	13,000	1,454	1,242
State incentives	up to US\$2.85bn	up to US\$80m	US\$62.9m
Taxpayer saving from renegotiation	-	US\$2.77bn	-

08

questions that must be answered

Thirty-three questions, addressed to the parties who hold the answers. None requires a study that does not already exist.

TO BCDA

1. Where exactly is the parcel? Publish Annex A.
2. Does the exclusive-use clause at §II.3 permit private industrial locators

TO THE EXECUTIVE, DFA AND DOF

1. Will the framework be submitted to the Senate? If not, on the basis of what legal opinion?

such as Foxconn? If not, what instrument changes it, and under what authority?

3. Why does §III cite Republic Act No. 7277, the Magna Carta for Disabled Persons, as the Bases Conversion and Development Act, and why has it not been corrected?
4. What is the intended activity mix, in hectares and in capital?
5. Publish the studies behind every headline figure. Who conducted them, when, and on what assumptions?
6. What is the composition of the PHP 68–75bn withholding tax figure, and what average annual wage does it assume?
7. What employment multiplier produces 500,000–800,000 indirect jobs, and from what source?
8. What is the assumed domestic value-added share of the US\$200bn in exports?
9. What is the proposed lease term and Year-3 rate, and on what independent valuation?
10. Is the United States the master lessee? May it sublease, transfer or collateralise, and to whom?
11. Who is the "US-based company serving as project proponent," and how was it selected?
12. Publish the water balance, the impounding dam design and

2. What governing law and dispute forum will apply?

3. Has a national security assessment of concentrating strategic assets at this site been conducted, and will it be published?
4. Given the USTR's 12.5% tariff, what trade-treatment commitments is the Philippines seeking in return for the Zone?
5. Which body, Cabinet, NEDA Board, or otherwise, has formally approved the Philippine position, and when?

footprint, and the abstraction volumes sought.

13. Publish the energy plan, including the DFC-scoped 1,200 MW LNG plant, and reconcile it with the statement that the project aims to avoid fossil fuels.
14. What was meant by wanting contracts "immune from any environmental situation"?
15. What is the estimated cost of fiscal incentives and of public enabling infrastructure?
16. Is the 40% open-space commitment binding on this parcel, and how is it reconciled with maximal rainwater capture?

TO NCIP, DENR, NWRB, DOE, NGCP
AND PCC

1. NCIP: has a certification precondition process been initiated? What is the status of the Aeta CADT applications over Capas filed in 1999, 2014 and 2019?
2. DENR: does any project-specific ECC exist for this parcel? Will a cumulative impact assessment be required?
3. NWRB: on what technical analysis was the sufficiency statement of 22 July 2026 made? Publish it.
4. DOE and NGCP: how will up to 3 GW be served, by when, at what cost, and who bears the reserve-margin and price risk?

TO THE UNITED STATES

1. What legal arrangements does the United States consider necessary to operationalise the Zone, the question the State Department declined to answer in May 2026?
2. What does "joint governance" mean concretely, and what does "fuse American expertise in institutions and legal regimes" require of Philippine law?
3. What, if any, US financial commitment exists beyond feasibility studies?
4. Will the Zone have any defence, dual-use or export-control function, and will the United States accept an express exclusion clause?

5. PCC: will the incentive package be reviewed for competitive neutrality against existing PEZA locators?

5. How does the United States reconcile designating the Philippines as the site of its flagship Economic Security Zone with imposing a 12.5% forced-labour tariff on Philippine exports?

TO PROSPECTIVE INVESTORS,
INCLUDING FOXCONN

1. Will you disclose your identity, capital commitment, employment commitment with a wage floor, technology-transfer commitment and local-content commitment as a condition of entry?
2. Foxconn specifically: given the Wisconsin experience, will you accept performance-linked clawbacks tied to verified investment and hiring?

09

what to watch, and when

Exhibit 14. Indicators that distinguish the scenarios from one another, grouped by the horizon on which they resolve.

TO JULY 2027

the decisive period

Monthly net sentiment on a constant method, the earliest available proxy for whether disclosure, if it comes, changes anything

TO 2029

delivery against milestones

Actual capital deployed versus the US\$10bn initial target

Whether site development began in Q1 2028 as targeted

The #NoToPaxSilica-to-#PaxSilica ratio, currently 50 against 105

The channel mix, and whether official communication reaches Facebook, Reddit and X rather than the news wire

The water and land topic share, currently one-sidedly negative and growing

Whether a framework is signed in November 2026, and whether its text is published

Whether Annex A, the water balance and the grid study are published

Whether the Year-3 rent and lease term are fixed at signature, which is the clearest available signal of whether the Philippines negotiated or capitulated

Whether the framework contains clawbacks, employment covenants and local-content obligations

Whether the Senate asserts a concurrence role; whether a Supreme Court petition is filed

Whether any investor is named with a binding commitment and financial close

Whether Foxconn proceeds beyond due diligence, the single most informative signal available

Whether the DFC LNG project reaches a final investment decision

Whether the DOE approves grid connection, and at what tranche size, measured against the 100–200 MW ceiling the Energy Secretary stated on 27 July 2026

Firm generation and water storage commissioned, ahead of load, or behind it

Verified employment against milestones; the foreign-worker share against the stated under-10%

Realised tax revenue and published tax expenditure

Resolution or continued non-resolution of the Aeta CADT applications

Whether local suppliers have entered the value chain, and how many

Luzon reserve margin and the frequency of yellow and red alerts

Whether dedicated generation, the LNG import terminal and the Subic–Clark pipeline advance beyond feasibility studies

Whether officials stop issuing new job figures

TO 2031

whether it changed anything

Domestic value-added share of Zone exports, the single most important development metric

Number, revenue and employment of Philippine-owned supplier firms serving the Zone

Whether any activity moved beyond ATP into advanced packaging, design or materials

Industrial electricity price versus Indonesia and Vietnam, and whether the gap closed

Water availability for Tarlac agriculture; groundwater levels; drought performance

Compliance record: ECC violations, hazardous waste incidents, labour disputes

Whether the Zone remained multilateral or became bilateral in substance

Whether emissions are consistent with the Philippines' NDC

about this assessment

Independent and Philippines-centred. Decision-grade means it supports one decision: whether to sign in November. It is not engineering-grade or transaction due-diligence grade. Site v1.12, reflecting assessment v2.8. Maintained as a living document: project facts verified to 2 August 2026, last updated 3 August 2026, with weekly review and immediate review on trigger events. Comparator, legal and technical sources verified through 2 August 2026. The fifth State of the Nation Address of 27 July is incorporated from the Official Gazette transcript. Nothing is silently revised: every substantive change is versioned and logged, and a correction to something previously published is stated as a correction rather than edited away. The version current when the November framework is signed will be frozen as the permanent pre-signature record. Structured scoping review, not PRISMA-compliant and not described as such. A single integrated research synthesis. No human expert peer review has been obtained. No fieldwork.

known limitations

Only two Philippine primary documents are public. Annex A is referenced and absent. Site rainfall, catchment, aquifer and seismic data are unpublished, so the water and power models use parametric ranges that must be re-run against site data when it exists.

evidence tiers

Tier 1: US State Department media notes and fact sheets; the BCDA proposal letter and Note Verbale JMGR-NV-145-2026; PSA and CPBRD statistical series. Tier 2: Philippine national media. Tier 3: industry associations and analysis. Tier 4: stakeholder statements. Primary text beats characterisation throughout.

currency

PHP 61.85 = US\$1 throughout, the peso's record-low close of 24 July 2026. Where a source gives pesos, the figure is reported as given and converted.

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